

A FREE GUIDE BY JESSE MORAGA

THE FOUNDATION.

The one idea that lets you play in **any key** — and finally understand the guitar instead of guessing.

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WHY YOU'RE STUCK

IT'S NOT TALENT. IT'S THE MAP.

Most players memorize a few shapes and stay stuck in one key — lost the second a song moves somewhere new. That was me for two decades.

Here's what nobody told me: the guitar is **wired in repeating patterns**. The notes aren't random — they follow one simple rule of spacing. Learn that rule once, and the whole neck opens up. You stop memorizing and start *understanding*.

This guide hands you that rule, starting with the cleanest key on the instrument: **C major**. Master it here, and you'll be able to move it into **every other key** — that's the whole trick.

"Learn it the right way once, and you never go back to guessing."

STEP 1 · THE MAP

START WITH C MAJOR.

Every major scale is built from the same **pattern of steps** — whole steps (2 frets) and half steps (1 fret):

W — W — H — W — W — W — H

Start that pattern on **C** and you get C major — the one scale with **no sharps or flats**. That's why it's the perfect place to learn:



Those seven notes are the home base for thousands of songs. See them light up across the whole fretboard in **Fr3tLab** (free, link on the last page):

FR3TLAB scales · chords · arpeggios · progressions · identifier — any tuning **C Major (Ionian)** [sound on](#)

MODE
Scales Chords Arpeggios Progressions Identifier

ROOT
C C# D D# E F F# G G# A A# B

SCALE / MODE Major (Ionian) **TUNING** Standard E **STRINGS** — 6 + 6 7 8

PER-STRING TUNING (LOW → HIGH)
1 E 2 2 A 2 3 D 3 4 G 3 5 B 3 6 E 4

LABELS Notes Degrees **HANDED** Right **CAPO** — — + **FRETS SHOWN** from — 0 + to — 16 +

TUN	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
E	E	F		G		A		B	C		D		E	F	
B	B	C		D		E	F	G			A		B	C	
G	G		A		B	C		D		E	F		G		A

The Foundation — Play on Any Key [Fr3tLab](#) [guitar.com](#)

STEP 2 · THE UNLOCK

NOW PLAY IT IN **ANY KEY.**

Here's the part that changed everything for me. Because a major scale is just that **pattern of steps** — not a fixed set of notes — you can start it *anywhere*.

Keep the exact same spacing (W–W–H–W–W–W–H) and begin on a different note. Same shape, new key. For example, start on **G**:



That's G major. Same pattern as C — it just produced one sharp (F#) because of where it started. Do the same from D, from A, from any note, and you can play in all 12 keys.

Move the shape, keep the spacing — that's playing in any key.

Once your hands know the pattern and your ear knows the sound, you're not guessing anymore. You're choosing.

STEP 3 · MAKE IT STICK

YOUR FIRST WEEK.

Ten focused minutes a day beats an hour of noodling. Do this:

- **Day 1–2:** Play C major up and down, slowly, **saying each note name out loud** (C-D-E-F-G-A-B).
- **Day 3–4:** Move the same pattern to G major. Say those names too.
- **Day 5–6:** Pick a song you like and find which of these notes fit over it.
- **Day 7:** Try the pattern from a brand-new starting note — no help. That's playing in a new key on your own.

Open [Fr3tLab](#) while you practice — pick any key and watch the whole map appear, so your eyes and hands learn it together.

WANT ME IN YOUR CORNER?

This is page one. In a 1-on-1 lesson I build the rest of your foundation around exactly where you're stuck — any level, any time zone. Book a free 15-minute consult at jessemoragaguitar.com.